STEPHEN STASAITIS

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Portfolio • LinkedIn

PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

Built two AI products solo with zero marketing spend, reaching thousands of users. One is a visual discovery engine for 20,000+ Pokémon TCG cards and the other is a live fantasy baseball analytics platform. Scaled a delivery startup from launch to $4M+ revenue and 100k+ deliveries as employee #1. Found 12 critical vulnerabilities in a Google-partnered AI startup's production system, all patched. Self-taught. Looking for the right team to bring my mix of tech and business to.

SKILLS

- **Product:** Roadmap prioritization, technical scoping, user feedback loops, search quality evaluation
- **Technical:** Python, JavaScript, Flask, SQL, REST APIs, Git/GitHub, Firebase Auth, PostHog, Railway, Cloudflare R2
- **Search & ML:** XGBoost, embedding search, BM25, CLIP/SigLIP, multimodal retrieval, learned ranking, RAG, LLM integration
- **Data & Evaluation:** Data pipelines, API reliability, caching, NDCG evaluation, root cause analysis
- **Operations:** Incident response, escalation triage, process scaling, risk mitigation

WORK EXPERIENCE

Founder – Staiz.io Nov 2025 – Present

- Built and launched Staiz, a visual search engine for 20,000+ Pokémon TCG cards searchable by mood, scene, and style
- Gained 40 sign-ups and 2,500+ user searches within 72 hours of launch with zero marketing spend
- Designed a four-tower retrieval pipeline using CLIP, OpenAI text embeddings, BM25, and LLM-generated tags across query types
- Trained an XGBoost reranker with 55 features for similarity, matching, and feedback, raising NDCG@10 from 0.52 to 0.875
- Created the search evaluation workflow with test queries, 27,000+ graded judgments, and diagnostics to improve search quality

Founder – FantasyIntel.io Aug 2024 – Present

- Built a live fantasy baseball analytics platform integrating 15+ data sources with sub-second response times
- Designed a responsive console with 16 sortable columns, real-time filtering, and customizable weights across 30+ daily pitchers
- Architected a resilient data pipeline across 47 API endpoints with validation, failover, and real-time refresh
- Designed a proprietary scoring algorithm combining six weighted components for pitcher streaming recommendations
- Implemented an AI layer with Claude and LangChain for personalized matchup analysis

Head of Dispatch Operations – Courial | San Francisco, CA Feb 2021 – Jul 2024

- Scaled operations from launch to $4M+ in revenue, helping secure investment from Elemental Excelerator and Techstars
- Partnered with engineering to automate dispatch workflows and improve on time-fulfillment
- Led incident response during DDoS attacks and infrastructure failures, directing routing strategy to maintain service continuity
- Coordinated live communication across partners, drivers, and internal teams during critical disruptions
- Analyzed patterns across 100K+ deliveries to detect anomalies, identify bottlenecks, and drive operational improvements

NOTABLE PROJECTS

AI Assistant Red Team Security Assessment – Neurun (Google-partnered startup) Jan 2025 – Feb 2025

- Simulated adversarial prompt injection and logic mapping attacks on a production AI assistant deployed by a high-growth startup
- Identified 12 critical and 6 high-risk vulnerabilities, all patched

Cybersecurity Training & Homelab Projects – Self-Directed Aug 2024 – Present

- Configured an enterprise homelab with Active Directory, Windows and Linux VMs, Wazuh SIEM, Security Onion, and Postfix
- Deployed honeypots; tuned detections and incident response; mapped to MITRE ATT&CK
- Centralized log forwarding and alerting with correlation; hardened Postfix against spoofing and relay abuse

EDUCATION

Penn State University, University Park, PA – B.S. Finance (GPA 3.65/4.00) Dec 2019

ADDITIONAL DETAILS

- **Certifications:** CompTIA Security+ (SY0-701), CompTIA Network+ (N10-008)
- **Business Fraternity (Phi Chi Theta) & THON:** Helped raise $85,000+ for pediatric cancer research in a single year